

DAL at HOU · Sunday 2026-10-04 13:00 ET · Week 4 2026

League-wide only. Window: weeks 4–9, 2015–2025. $n \geq 10$. No team streaks. No half-EPA. Lines from nflverse games.csv (snapshot Oct 1). Scores and team-week stats through Week 3; EPA from play-by-play.

Line: DAL +3.0 / HOU -3.0, total 48.5. Trip: DAL → HOU 225 mi, 0 time zones. Rest: DAL 7 days, HOU 7 days. Roof: nan.

1. Season boxes

Wk	Team	Spot	Score	Line	ATS	Off yds	Rush	Pass EPA	Off EPA	Def EPA allowed	SR	TO
1	DAL	A at NYG	20–28	–3.0	miss	244	69	+10.4	+15.7	+23.9	0.48	1
2	DAL	H vs WAS	37–20	–3.5	cover	345	66	+15.1	+12.7	+2.2	0.56	0
3	DAL	N vs BAL	31–34	+3.0	push	424	148	+13.3	+8.6	+12.6	0.47	1
1	HOU	H vs BUF	31–36	+1.5	miss	398	124	+1.5	+5.6	+15.6	0.48	2
2	HOU	H vs CIN	6–20	–3.0	miss	413	60	–9.7	–18.9	–6.3	0.34	0
3	HOU	A at IND	17–19	–1.5	miss	237	70	–3.1	–4.5	–8.1	0.43	0

Last game EPA (PBP): DAL off +8.6, def allowed +12.6, net -3.9, SR 0.47. HOU off -4.5, def allowed -8.1, net +3.6, SR 0.43. Records: DAL 1–2, HOU 0–3. ATS: DAL 1–1, HOU 0–3.

2. Lookahead and rest

- DAL: last played week 3 (Sunday late window, home, lost by 3). 7 days rest. Week 5: home vs TB, non-division, Thursday night.
- HOU: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, road, lost by 2). 7 days rest. Week 5: road vs TEN, division, Sunday early window.

3. Sides — HOU -3.0

HOU (home favorite)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
home favorite	274–300–16	47.7%	590
Sunday early window home favorite	154–155–10	49.8%	319
home fav -1 to -3	91–103–9	46.9%	203
Sunday early window fav -1 to -3	102–106–10	49.0%	218

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off a 1-score loss, home favorite	63–85–3	42.6%	151
off an ATS miss, home favorite	117–146–8	44.5%	271
equal rest, home fav -1 to -3	49–68–5	41.9%	122
off an ATS miss, Sunday early window home favorite	58–77–5	43.0%	140
off a loss, home favorite	116–142–6	45.0%	264
off a 1-score loss, home fav -1 to -3	23–35–2	39.7%	60
off a 1-score loss, Sunday early window home favorite	29–42–2	40.8%	73
off yards ≤ 250 last, Sunday early window home favorite	7–14–1	33.3%	22
off a loss, home fav -1 to -3	43–58–5	42.6%	106
rush yards ≤ 75 last, Sunday early window home favorite	24–35	40.7%	59
rush yards ≤ 75 last, home favorite	50–65–4	43.5%	119
off an ATS miss, home fav -1 to -3	41–53–6	43.6%	100
equal rest, home favorite	163–186–10	46.7%	359
off a loss, Sunday early window home favorite	60–74–3	44.8%	137
next game is road, home favorite	185–209–8	47.0%	402
both off a loss, home fav -1 to -3	21–29–3	42.0%	53
lost last despite positive net EPA, home fav -1 to -3	9–5	64.3%	14
next game is division, Sunday early window fav -1 to -3	26–34	43.3%	60

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
opponent off a loss, home favorite	147–165–7	47.1%	319
off a 1-score loss, Sunday early window fav –1 to –3	22–29–2	43.1%	53
off a road game, Sunday early window fav –1 to –3	49–59–7	45.4%	115
off EPA ≤0 last, home favorite	99–113–5	46.7%	217
next game is road, home fav –1 to –3	61–72–4	45.9%	137
off yards ≤250 last, Sunday early window fav –1 to –3	7–11–1	38.9%	19
lost last despite positive net EPA, Sunday early window fav –1 to –3	7–4–1	63.6%	12
next game is division, home favorite	86–98–1	46.7%	185
both off a loss, Sunday early window fav –1 to –3	23–29–2	44.2%	54
0 turnovers last, home favorite	94–83–3	53.1%	180

Wide populations (n ≥ 300): equal rest, home favorite, next game is road, home favorite, opponent off a loss, home favorite. They describe the spot, they do not select this game.

4. Sides — DAL +3.0

Mirror of the chair above. Same games, other side.

DAL (road dog)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
road dog	300–274–16	52.3%	590
Sunday early window road dog	155–154–10	50.2%	319
road dog +1 to +3	103–91–9	53.1%	203
Sunday early window dog +1 to +3	106–102–10	51.0%	218

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
off EPA ≥ +8 last, road dog +1 to +3	41–19	68.3%	60
pass EPA ≥ +10 last, road dog +1 to +3	35–17	67.3%	52
trip 200–1000 mi, road dog	179–135–6	57.0%	320
trip 200–1000 mi, Sunday early window dog +1 to +3	41–22–2	65.1%	65
pass EPA ≥ +10 last, Sunday early window road dog	40–22–2	64.5%	64
pass EPA ≥ +10 last, road dog	63–40–2	61.2%	105
TO ≤1 last, road dog +1 to +3	77–52–5	59.7%	134
trip 200–1000 mi, road dog +1 to +3	64–42–3	60.4%	109
next game is prime time, road dog	59–38–2	60.8%	99
off EPA ≥ +8 last, road dog	78–54–1	59.1%	133
lost last despite positive off EPA, road dog	50–32–3	61.0%	85
trip 200–1000 mi, Sunday early window road dog	107–81–3	56.9%	191
opponent off an ATS miss, road dog	146–117–8	55.5%	271
equal rest, road dog +1 to +3	68–49–5	58.1%	122
off EPA ≥ +8 last, Sunday early window road dog	43–29–1	59.7%	73
opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday early window road dog	77–58–5	57.0%	140
next game is prime time, road dog +1 to +3	24–14	63.2%	38
opponent off a loss, road dog	142–116–6	55.0%	264
scored ≥30 last, road dog +1 to +3	34–22–2	60.7%	58
off a home game, road dog	216–184–12	54.0%	412
off a 1-score loss, road dog	90–70–5	56.2%	165
next game is prime time, Sunday early window road dog	32–21–1	60.4%	54
opponent off a loss, road dog +1 to +3	58–43–5	57.4%	106

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
TO ≤1 last, road dog	181–154–7	54.0%	342
next game is Thursday (short week ahead), road dog	15–8–1	65.2%	24
next game is Thursday (short week ahead), Sunday early window road dog	12–6–1	66.7%	19
allowed ≥30 last, Sunday early window dog +1 to +3	26–37–2	41.3%	65
scored ≥30 last, road dog	75–59–5	56.0%	139

Wide populations (n ≥ 300): trip 200–1000 mi, road dog, off a home game, road dog, TO ≤1 last, road dog. They describe the spot, they do not select this game.

5. Total 48.5

Cut	Over–Under	Over pct	n
Sunday early window, line within 3, total 45–49	44–32	57.9%	76
line within 3, total 45–49	75–61–1	55.1%	137
Sunday early window, total 45–49	106–90–1	54.1%	197
Sunday early window, total ≥47	93–81–3	53.4%	177
Sunday early window	267–249–5	51.7%	521
line within 3, total ≥47	63–71–3	47.0%	137
total ≥47	167–179–5	48.3%	351
total 45–49	187–175–2	51.7%	364
line within 3	185–194–5	48.8%	384
Sunday early window, line within 3	107–110–2	49.3%	219
Sunday early window, line within 3, total ≥47	37–37–1	50.0%	75

6. What does not apply

- 2+ time-zone trip: no
- double-digit dog: no
- off a 10-point loss: no
- off a 20-point win: no
- 2nd straight home game: no
- 2nd straight road game: no
- bye next week: no
- off a bye: no
- scored ≤10 last: no
- short week: no
- trip ≥1000 mi: no
- TO ≥3 last: no
- undefeated entering: no
- winless entering: no

7. Stack, without double-counting

- **HOU –3.0** — one population: home fav –1 to –3; off a loss; off a 1-score loss; off an ATS miss; off a loss as favorite; off a road game; next game is road. ATS 8–5 (61.5%, n=13). Not added (n would fall under 10, or the trait does not narrow the population): off a division game, next game is division, equal rest, opponent off a loss, both off a loss, scored ≤17 last, scored ≤21 last, allowed ≤21 last....
- **DAL +3.0** — one population: road dog +1 to +3; off a loss; off a 1-score loss; off a loss as dog; off a home game; equal rest. ATS 6–4–1 (60.0%, n=11). Not added (n would fall under 10, or the trait does not narrow the population): trip 200–1000 mi, 0 time zones, next game is home, next game is home non-division, next game is prime time, next game is Thursday (short week ahead), opponent off a loss, opponent off an ATS miss....

Feeds: nflverse games.csv (lines, scores, rest), stats_team_week 2015–2026 (yards, pass EPA, TO), play_by_play 2015–2026 (off/def EPA, success rate), data/airports.csv (miles, zones).